



Anime backdrops

Have a look at some of the more beautiful anime backdrops with the characters removed. You might be surprised <http://dgit.in/Y00KFI>

Poor Apple

A slideshow illuminating 5 reasons Wall Street hates Apple. <http://dgit.in/141hdgT>



Samsung NX1000

quite significantly when turned on. If the camera accidentally gets turned on while it's in your bag, the lens is most likely to get damaged. However, that wasn't nearly as bad as the kit glass on the Samsung NX1000. While the camera itself feels as sturdy as the Galaxy Camera, the lens feels very poorly built. Many a time, the lens would creek under the gentle push of our fingers and sometimes it felt like the internals were rubbing together while zooming. This is behavior you DO NOT want in your camera lens.

The ergonomics of each camera were rather distinct, not just between brands, but within each camera too. The Olympus OM-D E-M5 and the Olympus PEN- E-PL5, though coming from the same manufacturer, had a different button layout. Each of these will take a little getting used to, but we loved how most of them provided a configurable "fn" button. In fact, a configurable "fn" button is extremely important to allow quick access to features. We scored favorably for cameras that provided at least one such

button, along with a physical exposure compensation dial. A viewfinder also was favorable, but the most number of points went to ease of access to each of the functions of the camera.

IMAGE PERFORMANCE

The studio tests for ISO performance were limited strictly to native ISOs, which by default is ISO 6400. The reason for this is that ISOs higher than 6400 are classified as "expanded ISO" which means they're software enhanced and don't strictly adhere to the ISO standard. In our studio tests, the cameras with the larger sensor had an obvious advantage over the ones with a 4/3-inch silicon chip. Here, up to ISO 1600, all cameras maintained a very clean, noise-free image. Upon moving up to ISO 3200, we started seeing the smaller sensors of the Olympus and Panasonics show signs of noise, particularly with the shadows getting blocked up noticeably so. The Fujifilm X-E1 and X-Pro1 maintained a very fine grain, which was only

discernable once the image was zoomed in at 100 percent. The Sony NEX-6 also managed to keep noise levels low, but not as low as the Fujifilm. In fact, while the Fujifilm noise was a very fine grain, the noise pattern on the NEX-6 was more noticeable, something very similar to a salt-and-pepper noise pattern. Even when looking at the dynamic range and contrast rendition, the Sony NEX-6 and the Fujifilm cameras stood at par with each other, but ahead of the competition.

We also wanted to measure center and edge sharpness using our test target, so we placed a soft toy with a lot of fibers on one edge of the target while the center had text-based targets. Shooting at lower ISOs with modern day cameras doesn't really do much, so we bumped up our testing standards and checked for sharpness and readability at ISO 1600, 3200 and 6400. So from our tests, the X-E1 and X-Pro1 maintained a strong lead due to a solid combination of excellent optics projecting the light onto a large sensor designed to capture more detail. The Sony NEX-6 was a close second with the OM-D E-M5 being a close third.

For real world testing, we found a few nice shrubs and flowers to shoot for our macro test and some bright spots with plenty of trees to check for real world contrast and dynamic range. In our test, we found that on neutral settings, the Olympus OM-D E-M5 produced some nice colours but the contrast levels weren't quite there. Also, we found the Olympus lenses to be susceptible to a lot of purple fringing when shooting in strong contrast lighting. The Panasonic GX1 and GF5 had a tendency to capture muted colours and therefore had a flat contrast curve also. Their lenses were a little better at handling chromatic aberrations (CA), but fell prey to some bad distortion and softness at the edges.

Where we found ourselves incredibly impressed was while using the Fujifilm duo. The X-Trans sensor is a proprietary design by Fujifilm and employs a magical arrangement of pixels which eliminates the need for an optical low pass filter and allows the camera to capture more colour information than a conventional sensor. The result was images with very good saturation levels (especially the greens) along with a



Olympus PEN E-PL5